

Noise Buds N1 Pro

Affordable, bass-boosted buds packed with features

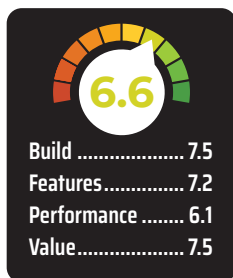
In an increasingly crowded TWS market, budget earbuds like the Noise Buds N1 Pro face stiff competition. These earbuds follow in the footsteps of their popular and more affordable sibling, the Noise Buds N1, which garnered significant attention from the Indian masses. However, with more brands such as Realme, boAt, and Xiaomi making waves in the budget space, the Noise Buds N1 Pro needs to deliver more than just the basics to stand out. Enter a compelling feature set: Active Noise Cancellation (ANC), Dual Pairing, and an IPX5 rating, all packed into an affordable price of just ₹1,799. At first glance, these features give the N1 Pro an edge over many competitors in its price bracket. But does the real-world performance live up to these promising specs? I've put the Noise Buds N1 Pro through rigorous testing to see if it truly stands out as a worthy competitor.

BUILD AND DESIGN

One of the standout features of the Noise Buds N1 Pro is its design. Upon unboxing, the earbuds present a sleek and minimalist aesthetic, with a matte finish that gives them a premium look despite their budget price tag. The compact case adds to the portability factor, easily fitting into pockets without creating any noticeable bulk.

The earbuds themselves are designed to fit comfortably in the ear, with silicone tips that offer a snug and secure fit. The design is sharp and angular, giving it a futuristic aura. The lightweight build also ensures prolonged use without causing discomfort.

The Noise Buds N1 Pro features IPX5 water resistance, which adds a



level of durability that many budget earbuds lack. However, while the overall build quality is pretty solid, the case hinge feels slightly fragile. It's a trade-off that might concern users looking for long-term durability, but for the price, it's an understandable compromise.

FEATURES

One of the key highlights of the Noise Buds N1 Pro is the inclusion of Active Noise Cancellation (ANC), a standout feature at this price point. Noise claims ANC can reduce sound by up to 32 dB, and while it doesn't rival premium earbuds, it performs well for its class. The ANC efficiently blocks out low-frequency background noise like air conditioners, traffic hum, and distant conversations, making a noticeable

difference in everyday settings such as offices or cafés. The buds also offer a Transparency Mode, but its execution feels somewhat artificial, lacking the clarity seen in more expensive options.

The Noise Buds N1 Pro supports Bluetooth 5.3, ensuring fast, stable connectivity with minimal drops or lag. Despite this, the initial pairing process is a bit cumbersome. The earbuds also feature dual pairing, allowing you to connect to two devices simultaneously and easily switch between them—ideal for multitaskers switching between phone calls and laptop audio.

Touch controls on each earbud let you manage playback, adjust volume, answer calls, and toggle between ANC and Transparency Mode. A dedicated Game Mode further enhances the experience by reducing latency to 40 ms, and it performs admirably. However, the lack of a companion app means there are no customisation options for the controls, which is disappointing.

SOUND QUALITY

The sound quality of the Noise Buds N1 Pro is where things get a bit dicey. Equipped with 11 mm drivers, these earbuds aim to deliver an overwhelmingly bass-forward sound signature, a hallmark of most budget-friendly TWS options. The result? The bass often overshadows the nuances and details in the mids and highs. While bass lovers may prefer this sound profile, audiophiles and purists will be turned off.

Vocals lack clarity and the highs, while crisp, are often drowned out by the overwhelming sub-bass. You can see the extension of the bass response in the frequency graph below.

Audiophiles or those expecting pristine clarity and instrument separation will find the N1 Pro lacking. The soundstage is narrow, and there's a lack of depth and detail compared to premium earbuds, but considering the price, the overall sound performance is acceptable for bass lovers.

When it comes to call quality, the Noise Buds N1 Pro performs reliably but